Proposal for Sankalan 2026

Organized by: Corporate Communications Committee

PGDM Business Management Program – BM38| MDI Gurgaon

Overview & Objective

Sankalan is the flagship panel discussion hosted by the Corporate Communications Committee of the PGDM Business Management program. The event serves as a platform where industry experts, influencers, and thought leaders converge to share forward-thinking insights with the MDI student community.

Sankalan 2026 is being reimagined to align more strongly with MDI's vision of thought leadership, corporate visibility, and meaningful student engagement. This year's edition introduces CaseQuest a business case competition giving students a hands-on platform to solve real-world business problems and showcase their analytical capabilities before industry leaders.

The focus will be equally centered on generating hiring opportunities for students and enhancing the program's brand visibility. This revamped format creates a dynamic platform for students to connect directly with industry leaders, gain meaningful insights, and unlock potential career opportunities. The event includes a panel discussion, CaseQuest business case competition, with cash prizes, high tea with panelists, and concludes with a cultural night for networking and celebration.

Event Details

- Date: 20th June 2026
- Time: 10:00 AM onwards
- Venue: Auditorium for Inauguration Ceremony, Panel Discussion [10 AM – 6PM]
- MDP hall: Cultural Night [7PM onwards]
- Participants: 57 students
- Guests: Chief Guest, Dean, Chairpersons, and esteemed faculty members
- Panelists: 7 + 1 Moderator

Panelists & Guests (tentative)

1. **Gopal C Sikder**
   Senior Executive Vice President I Project Director - Large Complex, Reliance Industries Limited
2. **Rushati Ghosh**
   GM Marketing Head — Business Octane Solutions Pvt Ltd
3. **Neha Gupta**
   Managing Director & Partner, Boston Consulting Group (BCG)
4. **Naveen Gulati**
   Group Chief Technology Officer, Modi Enterprises
5. **Somnath Das**
   Vice President — Supply Chain, Flipkart
6. **Rakhi Aswal**
   CFO — Saxo Group India
7. **Rajeev Singh**
   Vice President, Genpact – Manufacturing Finance & Transformation Leader

Discussion Topic

Zero-Based Strategy: Redesigning Corporate Roadmaps When Resources Shrink

Why it Works for a Diverse Panel

This theme acts as a strategic umbrella, allowing diverse experts to bring their distinct functional perspectives to the table. Marketing leaders can explore "Zero-Based Marketing," discussing how to execute flawless IMC and reach the top of the Brand Resonance Pyramid by earning attention rather than buying it. Finance heads can debate capital allocation and the friction between cost leadership and differentiation, while HR executives can address fostering intrapreneurship within lean, constrained teams. Finally, founders can share the ultimate masterclass in startup agility: ruthlessly prioritizing consumer needs without the safety net of abundant capital.

Why it is Highly Valuable for Students

For the batch, this theme seamlessly integrates academic frameworks such as A/B testing and competitive positioning with the hard-edged realities of the corporate world, closely mirroring the demanding 24-hour format of the new CaseQuest competition. Adopting this “zero-based” mindset is integral to management consulting, significantly sharpening students’ preparedness for strategic case interviews and complex business guesstimates. Ultimately, engaging with this theme signals to recruiters that the students are pragmatic, future-ready professionals capable of driving growth even when organisations are operating under intense pressure.

CaseQuest — Business Case Competition

CaseQuest is a newly introduced student-facing business case competition in Sankalan 2026. The competition is designed to simulate real-world business decision-making under time pressure, encouraging students to apply conceptual learning to live business scenarios.

Format and Rules

- The business case problem, which may be a real-world problem provided by one of the panelists, will be released 48-72 hours prior to the event, giving participating teams adequate time to analyse the situation and develop their solutions.
- Teams will first present their solutions to be evaluated by internal faculty. The best 3 teams will then advance to present their solutions during the main event before a panel of industry experts.
- Judging criteria will include analytical rigour, creativity of solution, feasibility, and presentation quality.
- The winning team(s) will be recognised with a cash prize and a certificate of excellence.

Objectives of CaseQuest

- Provide a structured platform for students to apply conceptual learning to real business problems.
- Foster teamwork, strategic thinking, and high-stakes presentation skills.
- Create visibility for student talent among industry panelists, potentially leading to recruitment interest.

- Enhance the intellectual depth and prestige of the Sankalan event.

Objectives & Strategic Outcomes

Objective	Description
Placement / Recruitment	Facilitate exposure to CXOs, function heads, and creators for long-term brand-building and placement synergy
Branding	Position MDI as a hub for future-facing conversations by amplifying the event through LinkedIn and social media
Student Learning	Exposure to real-world insights across domains: marketing, finance, leadership, entrepreneurship, etc.
CaseQuest — Applied Learning	Hands-on case competition where students solve real business problems and showcase analytical and strategic skills to industry panelists
Student Involvement	Strengthen peer engagement, boost participation, and make MDI events more vibrant and visible

Schedule

Time	Agenda
10:00 AM – 11:00 AM	Inauguration Ceremony – Welcome Address, Felicitation of Chief Guest, Distinguished Guests
11:00 AM – 12:30 PM	CaseQuest — Business Case Competition: Team Presentations & Judging
12:30 PM – 1:30 PM	Lunch for Students & Faculty
1:30 PM – 3:00 PM	Preparation & Arrival of Panelists
3:00 PM – 4:30 PM	Panel Discussion with Q&A (winners earn 1-on-1 High Tea with panelist)
4:30 PM – 5:30 PM	High Tea with Panelists
5:30 PM – 7:00 PM	Break
7:00 PM onwards	Get-together and Dinner

Event Format

- Panel Discussion with 4–5 esteemed professionals (mix of CXOs, HRs, influencers, entrepreneurs)
- Interactive Q&A with students
- CaseQuest — Business Case Competition (case problem released one day prior to the event)
- Student Engagement Activities:
  - Live Polls + Audience Questions
  - Social media contests (LinkedIn) + giveaways

Budget Estimates

Note: Budget has been revised upward from the previous year to account for inflation (approx. 10–15% across categories), increased participant count (57 vs. 54 previously), increased panellists (7 vs 4) and the addition of CaseQuest.

S.No.	Category	Total (INR)
1	Flower Decoration of venue, bouquet & plants for gifting	15,000
2	Photography and Videography	18,000
3	Promotion Props (Standee, Banner, Selfie & Memory Board)	20,000
4	Rewards for Student Competitions (CaseQuest)	25,000
5	Lunch and Hi-Tea (Guests, Faculty and Students) *(approx. 10-12 Guests/Alums+5 Faculties+57 students=72-74 persons)*	30,000
6	Felicitation of Guests and dignitaries (Laptop Bag, books and MDI logo embossed corporate gifts) – *approx. 10 Nos.*	38,000
7	Get-Together and Dinner with Guests, Alums and students (Décor, Musical setup and lighting)* – *approx. 65-70 total*	75,000
8	Domestic Conveyance	25,000
9	CaseQuest — Competition Setup (case printing, evaluation materials, certificates, prizes)	7,500
	TOTAL (INR)	**2,53,500**

**The Guests have been requested to interact with the students and alums after the event concludes, we are expecting 3-4 guests to stay back for the informal interaction. The estimates have been calculated on the basis of tentative confirmations and also to create an informal setup for interactions.*

- These are tentative estimated prices, as per our discussion with the vendors and revised upward from the previous year. Final prices may vary as per actuals.
- To secure vendors and confirm arrangements in advance, we request 80% advance payment; the remaining 20% will be adjusted post-event against submission of bills and receipts.
- Advance Transfer Details:

  Name: Manasi Sharma

  Bank Name: ICICI Bank

  Account Number: 192901503858

  IFSC Code: ICICI0001929

- The designated member will take full responsibility for submitting final bills post-event and returning any unutilized funds.

Expected Outcomes

- Generate placement prospects for the batch through direct exposure to industry leaders.
- Creation of long-term corporate goodwill with the institute for the hiring of BM program executives.
- Amplification of MDI's brand visibility in media and on LinkedIn.
- Post-event content creation: reels, posts, and LinkedIn summaries.

- Showcase student talent and analytical capability through CaseQuest, potentially attracting recruitment interest from panelists.
- Strengthened alumni and corporate network through meaningful engagement.
- The Secretary, PGDM-BM Corporate Communications Committee will take complete responsibility for submitting self-attested final bills post-event and returning any unutilized funds.



(Manasi Sharma)
38BM24
Secretary
PGDM-BM Corporate Communications Committee